

English 401 S – Fall 2017
Fensom

TR (10-11:30 or 1-2:30)
8/31-12/14

COURSE: English 401S, Literacy Studio (17168 – M1 – Room 514; 17346 – M2 – Room 367)

INSTRUCTOR: Gail Fensom

OFFICE HOURS BY APPOINTMENT – Room 453

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TEXTS:

Lunsford, Andrea A. *The St. Martin's Handbook*, 6th ed. Boston: Bedford/St. Martin's, 2008.

About 50% of students graduating from high school today do not have sufficient competency in reading, writing, thinking and researching to pass an introductory first year composition course, like English 401. UNH Manchester both recognizes this and has chosen to help students by doing something about it.

The Literacy Studio is a specially-designed course for those who come to First Year Writing with questions about the sufficiency of their background in reading, writing, thinking and researching to earn a passing grade in the 4-credit course. Most of you have self-identified as needing some assistance in succeeding in English 401, so you will see the benefits of this course.

The Literacy Studio is linked only to 2 sections of Gail Fensom's English 401. It provides assistance for students in understanding and completing successfully the assignments in that course. The curriculum, then, follows exactly the demands asked of you in your English 401 section.

The course will help you develop strategies to read the complex texts demanded of you in college, texts that contain sophisticated vocabulary, nuanced ideas and expectations of background information. We will also look very closely at how writing is planned, executed and revised—examining draft writing to determine how to improve it (in terms of ideas, writing style and editing (spelling, punctuation, grammar)). This course allows for individual attention to your specific literacy challenges.

The goal is for you to successfully complete the assignments in English 401. At the same time, you will take away from this class several strategies that you can tailor to your next challenges in reading, writing, thinking and researching.

Participation

You are expected to come to class prepared for the work we have to do, and will be actively engaged in demonstrating your understandings to the class.

You may miss one class this semester (or be late to class twice) without academic penalty. After that, each absence or pair of lates will reduce your grade the equivalent of 5 points. Two sections of this course are offered on Thursday, 10-11:30 or 1-2:30. Plan to attend the section you have signed up for. However, if necessary, you may attend the other section occasionally. Just let me know.

Grading

This is a credit-fail course. I will keep you informed of your progress. If, in my estimation of your competencies, you have not fully engaged in the work of this course and developed required skills to the level expected, you will not pass the course (or, probably, English 401).

My efforts will be aimed at your success in both courses.

Conferencing

You are required to conference with me 5 times, and with a tutor 3 times, for English 401. English 401S does not require conferencing beyond those requirements.

However, you are always welcome to conference with me as often as you like.

Course Schedule and Assignments

We will follow the course schedule outlined for English 401, and engage in activities directly related to the assignments in that course. Treat these activities as assignments.

At the end of the semester, you will be assigned a reflective essay about how you have developed in this course. (See separate assignment)